

the system console. The second line that appears on the screen represents the login prompt. As FreeBSD is a multi-user system, it needs to have some system to differentiate between its many users. It accomplishes this objective by making it mandatory for every user to first log into the system before allowing them access to any present or running programs on the system.

Every user is granted a unique username and a personal password that distinguishes it from the rest. To log into the system console, one has to feed in the username set up at the time of system installation and press the 'Enter' button. Post this; they are required to type the password linked with their username and press 'Enter' again. For security purposes, the password doesn't echo (display when typed) in the FreeBSD environment. Once you've entered the correct password, the message of the day (MOTD)

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da14 at mpt1 bus 0 mchsm1 target 7 lun 0
da14: <VBOX HARDDISK 1.0> Fixed Direct Access SCSI-5 device
da14: 300.000MB/s transfers
da14: Command Queuing enabled
da14: 20480MB (41943040 512 byte sectors: 255H 633/T 2610C)
Trying to mount root from zfs:zroot
Setting hostuuid: 6948d4db-6503-4dba-9bid-c7a8af39359b.
Setting hostid: 0x0bcc89f7.
Entropy harvesting: interrupts ethernet point_to_point kickstart.
Starting file system checks:
Mounting local file systems:
vboxguest:0 port 0x0020-0x003f mem 0xf0400000-0xf07fffff,0xf0000000-0xf0003fff io
g 0 at device 4.0 on pci0
vboxguest:0: [ITHREAD]
vboxguest: loaded successfully
Setting hostname: freebsd-zfsmirror-test.bsd.net.
Starting Network: lo0 em0.
lo0: flags=8049<UP,LOOPBACK,RUNNING,MULTICAST> metric 0 mtu 16384
options=3<RXCSUM,TXCSUM>
inet6 fe80::1::lo0 prefixlen 64 scopeid 0x2
inet6 ::1 prefixlen 120
inet 127.0.0.1 netmask 0xff000000
nd6 options=3<PERFORMNUD,ACCEPT_RTADV>
em0: flags=8843<UP,BROADCAST,RUNNING,SIMPLEX,MULTICAST> metric 0 mtu 1500
options=9b<RXCSUM,TXCSUM,VLAN_MTU,VLAN_HWTAGGING,VLAN_HWCSUM>
```

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A look at the FreeBSD virtual console

gets displayed on your screen. A command prompt follows this message. Based on the shell that was selected at the time of user creation, the prompt appearing on your screen varies between the characters '\$', '#', and '%.' The appearance of the prompt is essentially indicative of the user logging into the FreeBSD system console and getting access to the suite of available commands on the system.

The configuration of FreeBSD is such that it offers numerous virtual consoles by default to the users for inputting their commands. While one can use the system console to communicate with the system, a user operating from the command line at the keyboard of a FreeBSD system will, more often